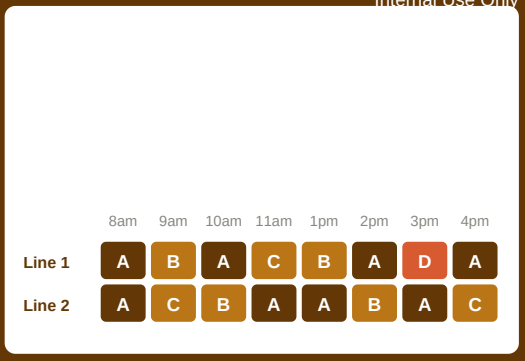
OPERATIONS

Internal Use Only

Heijunka

Level production volume and mix across a planning period to smooth demand on upstream processes, workforce, and



WHEN TO USE

When production scheduling creates peaks and valleys that stress resources and cause excessive overtime and idle time alternately.

HOW TO APPLY — STEPS

1. Calculate average daily demand per product family over 4–8 weeks
2. Create a heijunka box with defined time slots
3. Load orders evenly across the planning period by volume and mix
4. Communicate the levelled schedule to production and supply
5. Measure schedule adherence and work to reduce variation

PRACTITIONER TIP

! You cannot level production while sales promises custom delivery windows to every customer. Align commercial and operations first.

KEY OUTPUTS

- Heijunka scheduling box
- Levelled production schedule
- Volume smoothing trend chart

HOW TO MEASURE SUCCESS

Production levelling index; schedule adherence rate; WIP inventory reduction %

TOOL CATEGORY

Operations